

Inishbofin

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The title of this piece is “Inishbofin”. Inishbofin is a small island off the coast of Connemara, County Galway, with a population of around 180 inhabitants. The goal of this piece was to create a relaxing, atmospheric video based on a trip to Inishbofin to showcase the beauty of the island. I wanted to capture the Island’s peaceful nature and highlight the natural beauty of its landscapes.

Throughout the project, I used Adobe Premiere Pro and After Effects to edit the video. It is mainly an artistic project, with the goal of being visually appealing and reflecting the tranquillity of the island.

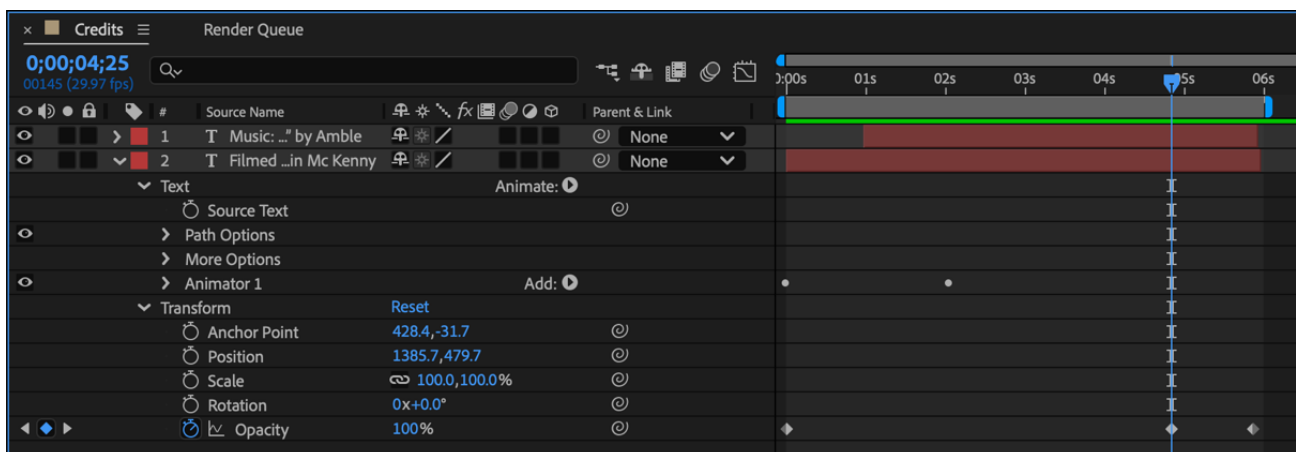
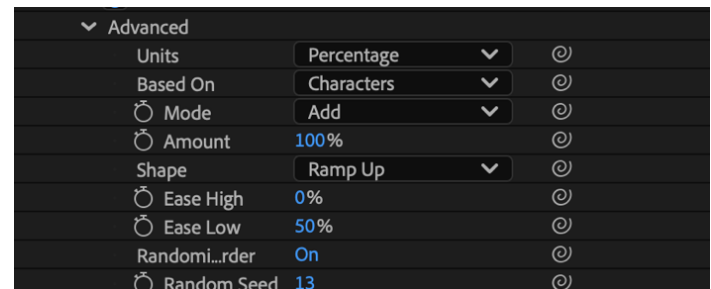
All video footage and photos were taken by me during the trip. For the audio, I downloaded the song, “Marys Pub” by Amble (Amble, 2023) from online. The majority of the ambient sounds used in the video were recorded by myself on the island including waves crashing, wind and a camera shutter. I also downloaded some royalty free sounds from YouTube and Pixabay to enhance the audio and selected the music carefully to suit the mood of the piece. I constructed the video to be slow paced and I used various effects to help enhance the natural and peaceful environment of Inishbofin.

Text Effect 1: Name and student number and end credits

For the opening and the credits, I created a custom text effect in Adobe After Effects.

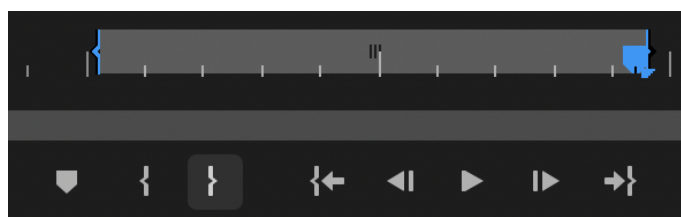


I first aligned the text both horizontally and vertically. I added a blur to the text and used keyframes to create a subtle fade in effect. At the start of the animation I set the opacity to be 0 and blur to be 100, making the text invisible and blurred. At the end, I set the opacity to 100 and blur to 0. This caused the text to fade in and become sharper. I used a randomised order for each letter to fade in, causing the letters to appear individually and at different times. This effect created a smooth, dynamic intro. I then exported these clips and imported them into Adobe premiere pro and placed them into my timeline.



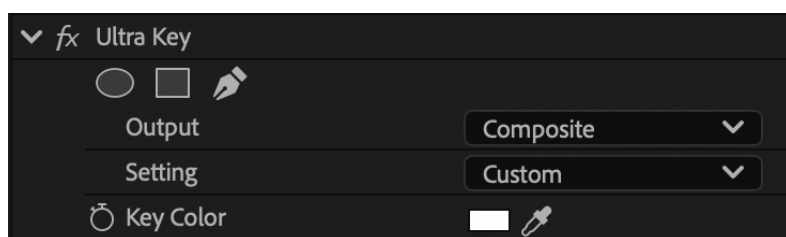
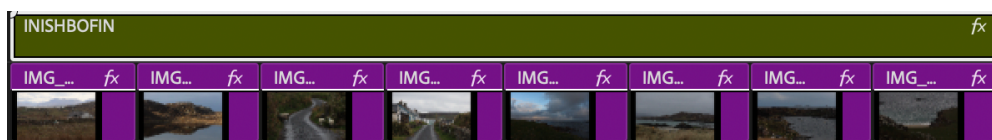
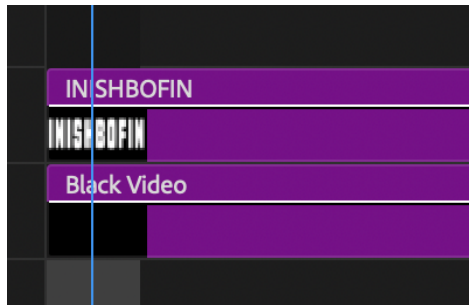
Editing Workflow:

I set in and out point in the Source monitor before dragging the clips to the timeline. This allowed me to easily remove sections I didn't want. I used multiple video and audio tracks to layer the footage, music and sound effects. I carefully aligned the cuts between videos with moments in music to maintain a slow, meaningful rhythm throughout the piece.



Inishbofin Title:

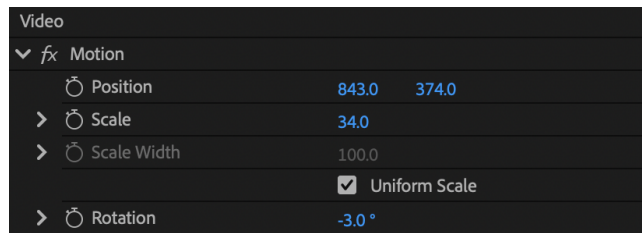
I designed a title sequence using images I had taken on the trip. I began with a black video layer as the background. I placed a text layer over it with the word “Inishbofin” in white. I adjusted the text properties to get a font and size that covered a large portion of the screen, and would allow for the images to be seen through the text.



I placed this sequence over a series of photos and used the ultra-key effect to make the white text transparent so the photos underneath became visible through the letter shapes.

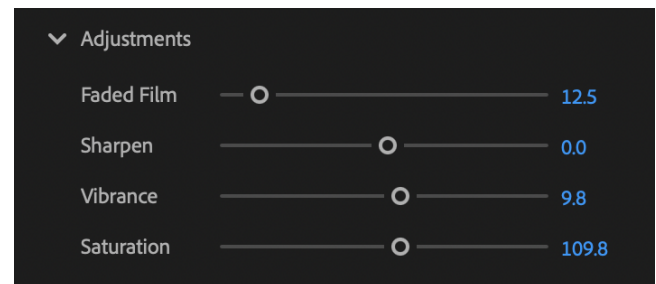


I adjusted the scale, position and rotation of the images beneath the text to make sure they were framed well within the letters and that key features like the sea and sheep weren't being cut out.

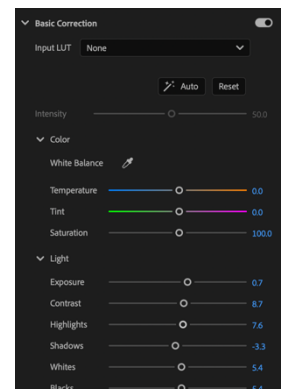


To make sure the title was legible I decided to use the Lumetri color effect on the images underneath. I adjusted their exposure, contrast, shadows, and highlights, and added a faded film effect for a slightly vintage cinematic look.

BEFORE:

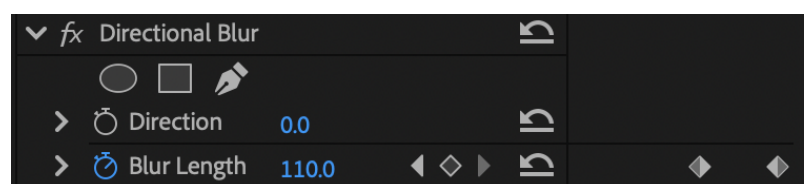


AFTER:



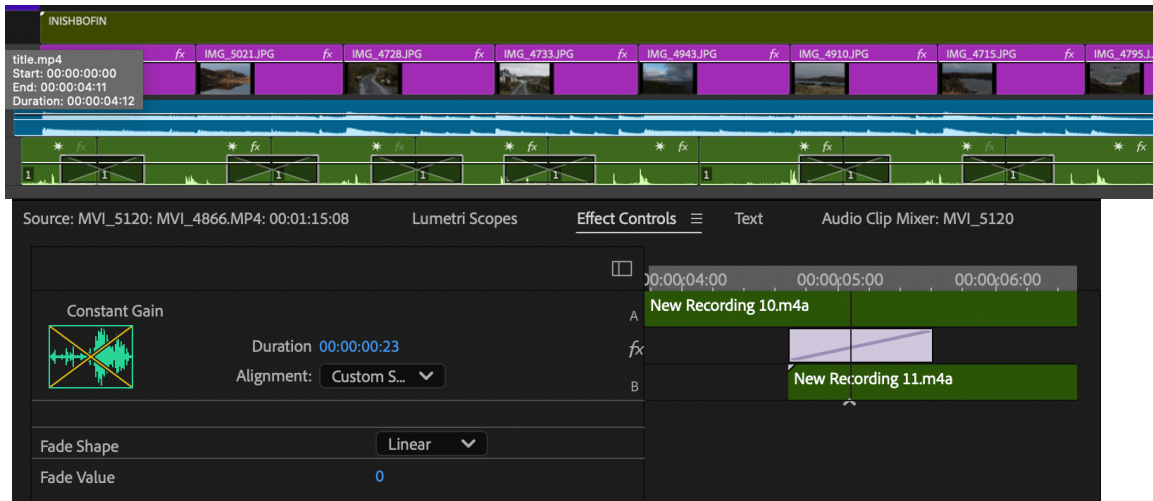
Transition 1: directional blur

To transition between the images I used a directional blur to simulate the sensation of flipping through photographs. I used keyframes to adjust the blur length. At the transition point I increased the blur to 110. I added a keyframe just before and after each transition and set the blur to 0. This effect helped to create a smooth, dynamic transition between the static images. This directional blur created the effect of flipping through photographs.



Sound Effects: Film camera

To add to the visual transitions between the photos, I recorded audio of a film camera shutter and also of the film advancing mechanism. I moved these audio clips so they aligned with the transitions between the photos. I adjusted the gain to ensure it wasn't too loud or distracting and I added a constant gain effect to fade the audio in and out smoothly.

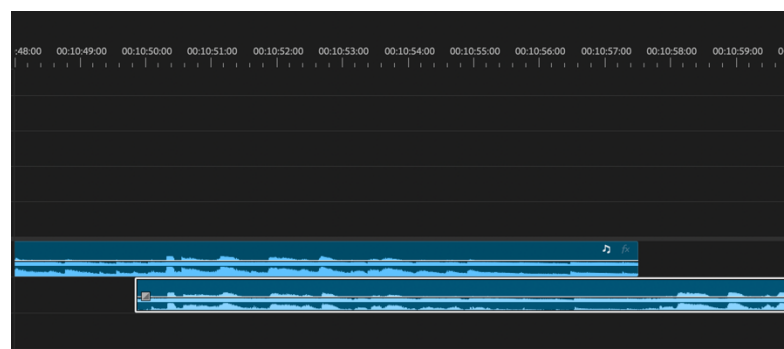
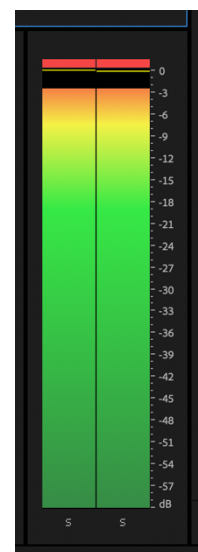
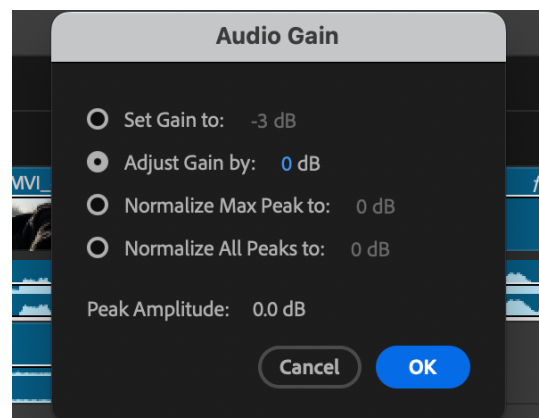


Music:

The main music track used in the piece is “Mary’s Pub” by Amble (Amble, 2023). I choose it because of its slow, nostalgic tone and lyrics that matched the islands peaceful atmosphere. When I imported the audio, the levels were peaking so I adjusted the gain by bringing it down a few DB.

The original song was too long so I decided to cut a section from the middle as I wanted to keep the intro and ending of the song.

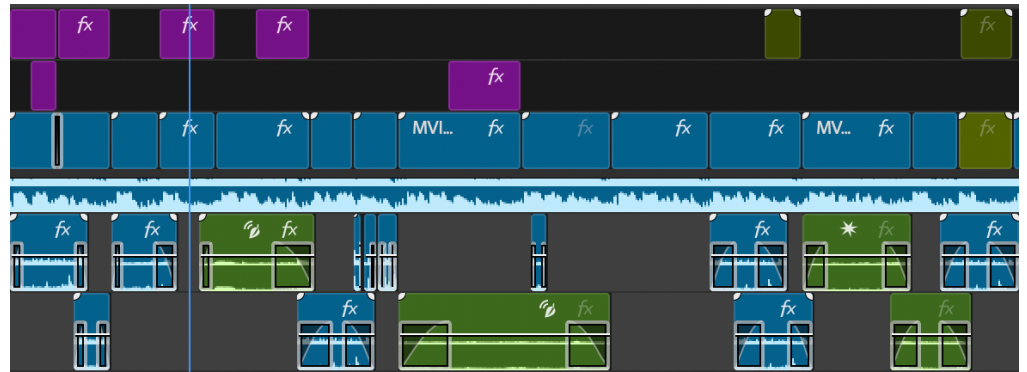
I used the razor tool to cut the track where I wanted. I then deleted the section in the middle. I placed the two remaining parts on separate audio tracks to help align them easily. I then added fade in/out effects to blend the audio together.



Ambient Sound Effects:

I layered several ambient sound effects throughout the piece. I used audio of the sea that I had recorded throughout the video. I downloaded audio of sheep bleating and eating (freesound_community, n.d.) I downloaded some nature sounds like wind and bird song (freesound_community, n.d.) and I also downloaded car interior noise (Sounds, 2020) to use as background noise to the clip in the car.

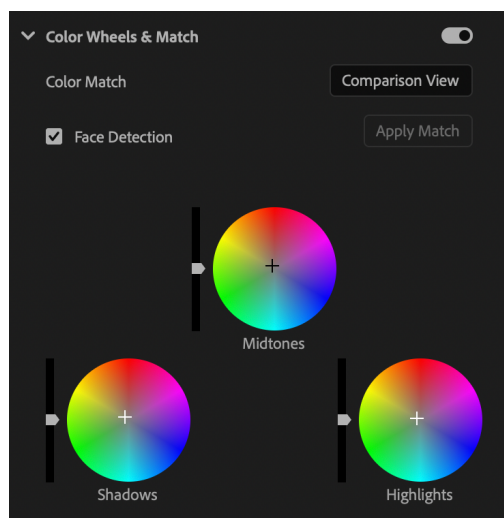
I mixed these layers by adjusting their volume, fading them in and out and also placing them strategically on the timeline so they matched with the visuals.



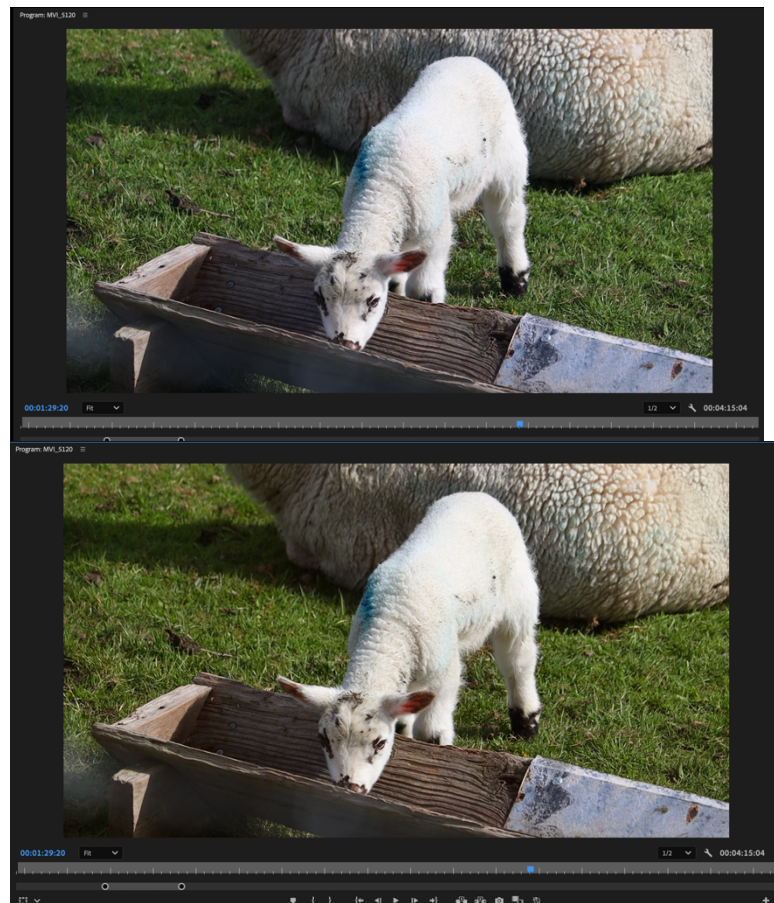
Lumetri Color: Colour correction

I made colour adjustments to the clips using Lumetri Color. For individual clips I used the basic correction panel to adjust the temperature, exposure and saturation. I wanted the clips to have a natural warm tone. I used the colour wheels to adjust the shadows, midtones and Highlights.

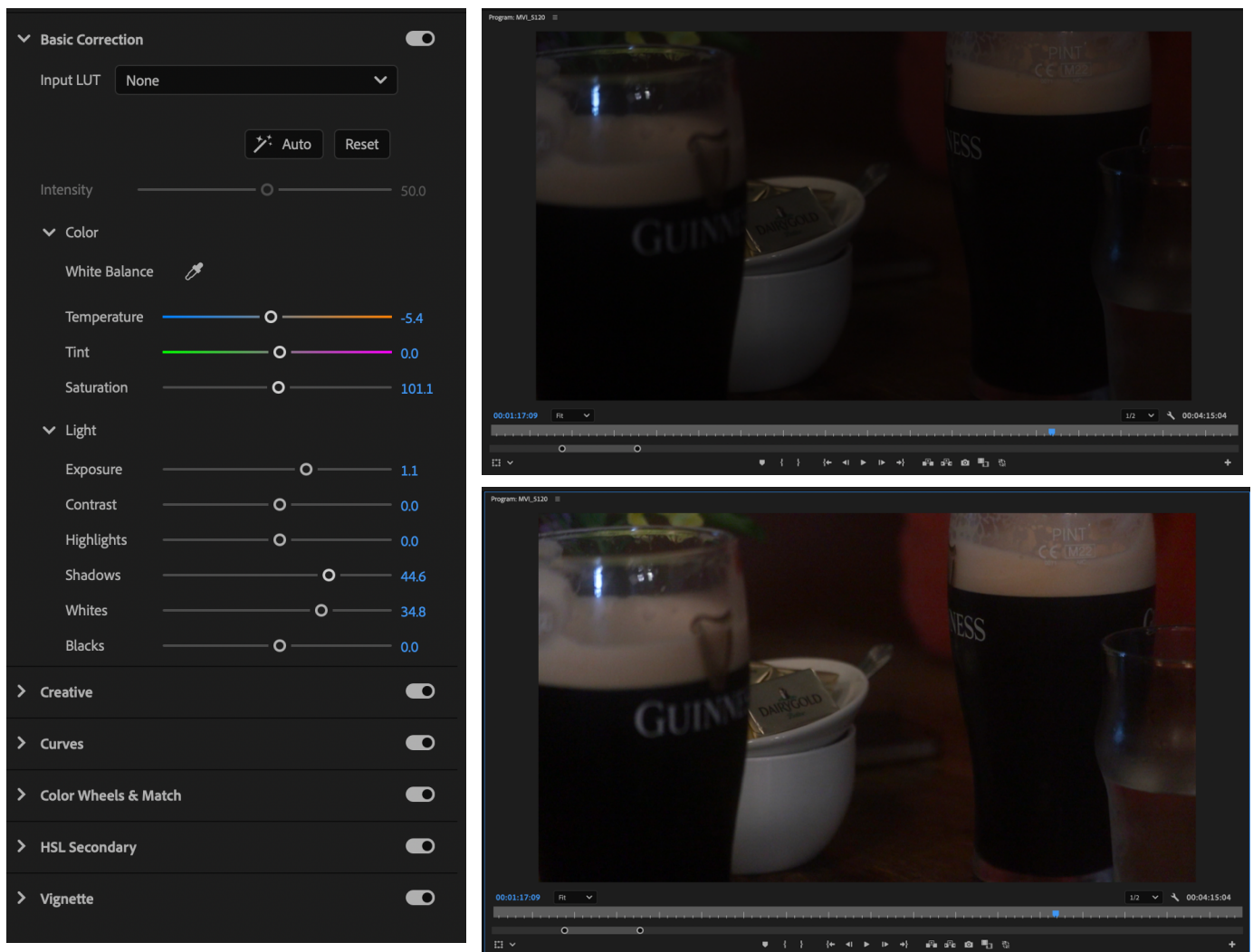
BEFORE:



AFTER:

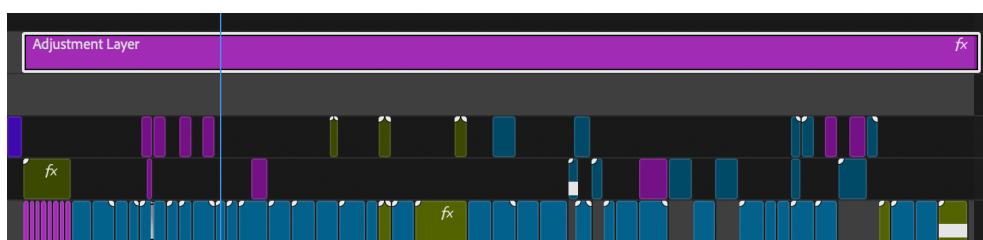


This clip of the Guinness was underexposed. In the basic correction panel of Lumetri colour. I increased the exposure, shadows, whites and saturation to brighten up the video and bring out some of the details.



Lumetri Color: Colour grading

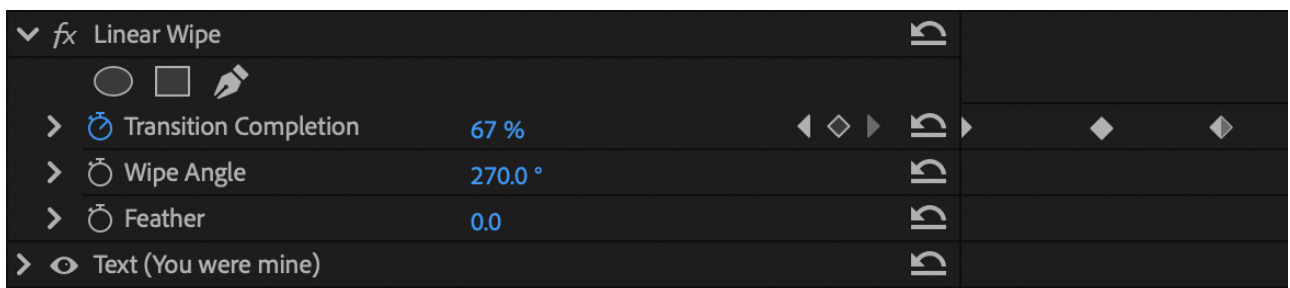
I wanted to keep a similar colour grade throughout the whole video so I created an adjustment layer over all the clips on the timeline. I added a creative look from creative panel in Lumetri colour to the adjustment layer so that it would apply to all the video clips. I adjusted the intensity so it wouldn't be too harsh and overwhelm the natural colours.



Text Effect 2: Linear wipe effect

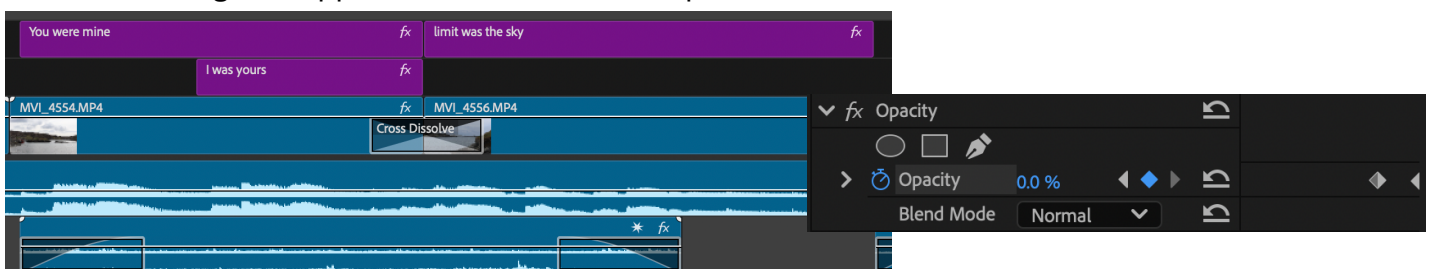
I used text selectively during certain parts of the piece to emphasize certain lyrics and make them more impactful.

For the first line of text “You were mine”, I added the linear wipe effect to simulate a typing effect. I set the wipe angle to 270 degrees so that the text would reveal from left to right. I then set 2 keyframes for the transition completion. The first was at 100 percent, so the text isn’t visible at all and the next was at 0 percent so the whole text is visible. To enhance the effect and match the lyrics of the song, I added a few extra Keyframes, making sure that each word appears in sync with the corresponding line in the song. This effect makes it feel like the words are being typed out as they are sung.



Transition 2: Cross Dissolve

I added a cross dissolve to the end of this clip so it smoothly transitioned into the next one. Since the text was overlaid on this clip, I wanted the text to fade out naturally with the footage. I keyframes the opacity of text layer, gradually fading it to 0% and ensuring it disappeared before the next clip.



Text Effect 3: Transform effects

For the text on the this clip I used the same linear effect as earlier but I also adjusted the scale of the video and the text.

The video clip was quite still so I keyframed the scale of it to create the illusion of movement, similar to the ken burns effect. I adjusted the scale of the text as well but I made the text expand even more. I thought this created an interesting effect with the movement of the text and the video behind.

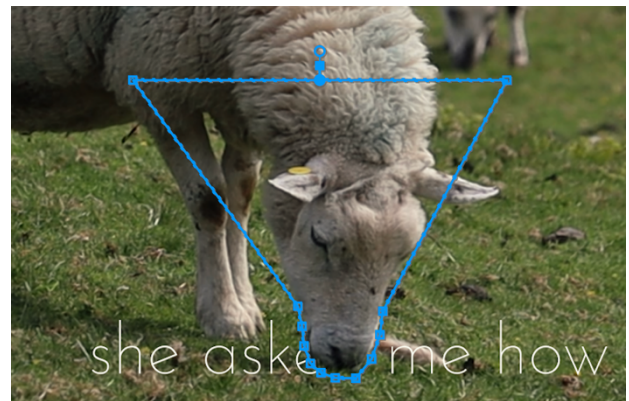
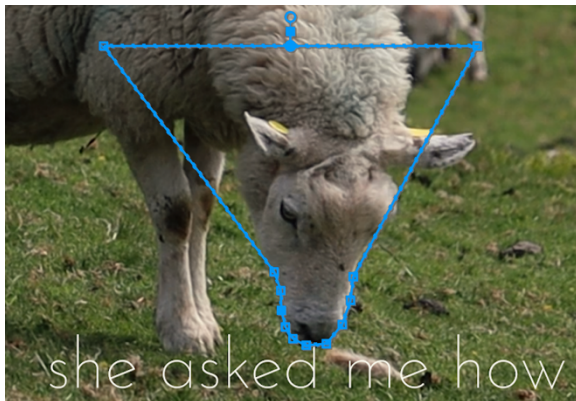


Text Effect 4: Masking

In the next clip of the sheep eating I used the linear wipe effect again but I then decided to create the effect of the sheep eating the letters.



On the text layer, I created a mask for the opacity and then inverted it so anything inside the mask would be transparent (opacity 0). I edited the mask around the sheep's mouth and created keyframes to track the movement of it.

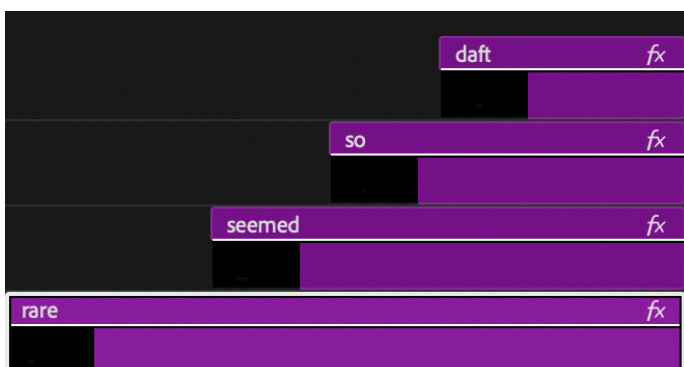
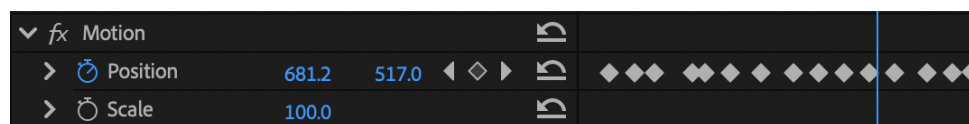


Text Effect 5: Transform effect



This is the text effect 3 times in the video

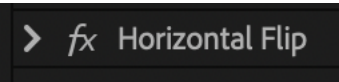
For this effect I used position keyframes to make the text appear as if it is staying fixed in the scene while the camera and subjects move around.

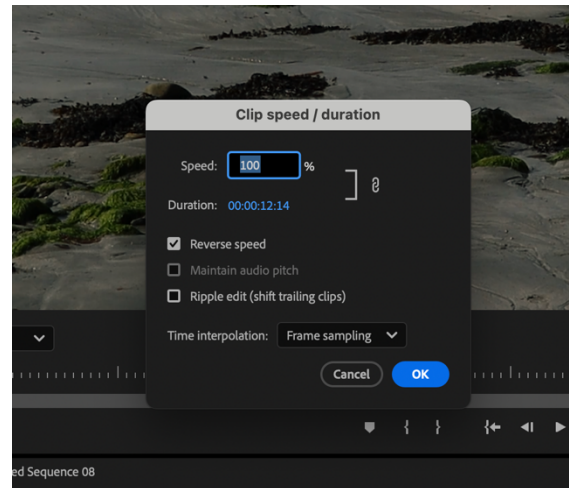


I put each piece of text on a different layer on the timeline so I could control when it appeared. I lined it up so that the words appeared as they were sung in the song and I also adjusted the position of each one so that it would appear beneath the footsteps.

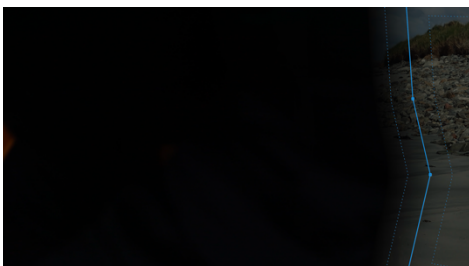
Speed change:

For the 'we are free' clip, the footsteps weren't lining up how I wanted them to so I decided to adjust the speed of the clip. I right clicked the clip and choose speed/duration. I changed it a few times to find a speed that worked. I also

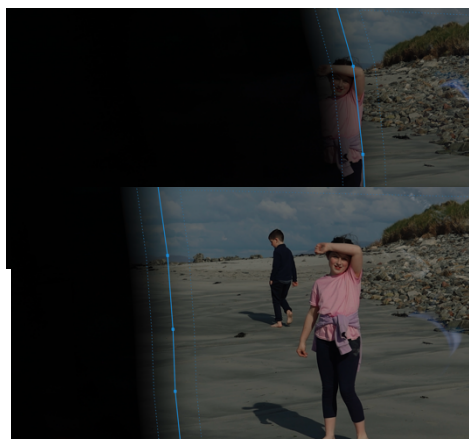
 used the horizontal flip effect on this clip in order to have Bill walking in the right direction for the text to appear from left to right.



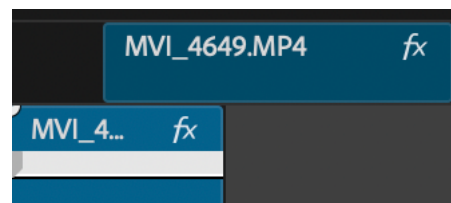
Transition Effect 3: masking + speed change



I used this effect to transition out of the clip of Bill walking across the frame. I slowed down this clip a bit with a speed adjustment as it was quite fast.



I placed the next clip of the kids on the beach onto the layer above. I then created an opacity mask on this clip. I used



keyframes to animate the mask path and I adjusted the mask to move in sync with Bill's movements across the frame, revealing the video underneath as he walked. I also created two keyframes for the opacity so that the new clip would start off darker and slowly fade in. This helped it to blend with the first clip that was quite dark.

Text Effect 6: transform + masking



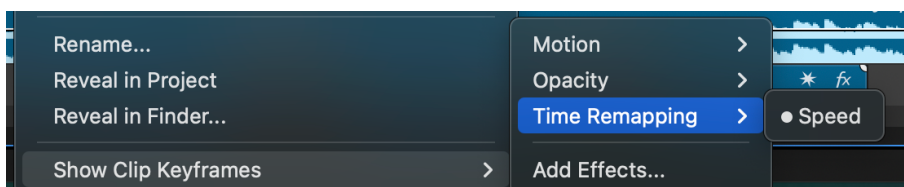
The fifth text effect I created was the text on the water “we are free”. For this effect I adjusted the x and y position values to place the text so it looks like it was floating on water in front of the boat. I decided that as the boat passed over the text, it should cover the text and the text should disappear. I did this by creating an opacity mask around the boat on the text layer. I used keyframes to follow the boat and I set the opacity to 0 within the mask.



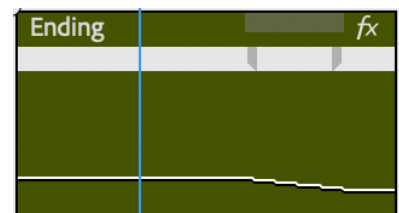
Ending: speed adjustments + fade out (transition to black)

For the last clip I decided to make a few adjustment to the speed. I first right clicked the clip and turned on the show clip keyframes feature for speed. This meant that I could

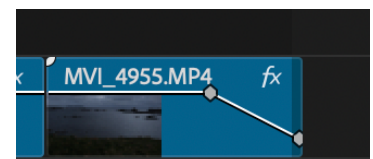
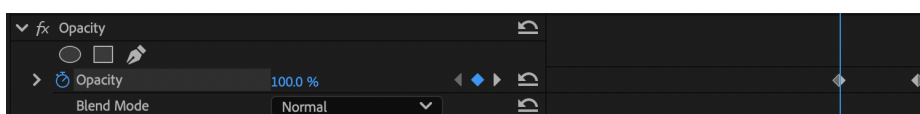
see and edit the clip’s speed directly on the timeline.



I added a key frame and adjusted the speed to be slower at the end of the clip. I created a linear ramp on the speed graph so that the clip got progressively slower rather than just suddenly shifting speeds.



To finish the video, I adjusted the opacity of the clip using keyframes to create a fade to black effect, allowing for a natural conclusion to the piece.



I really enjoyed working on this project and I'm very happy with the final project. The audio editing was a learning experience, and it made me realise how impactful sound is in a video project. If I were to do this projet again I would spend some more time on the colour grading, to give a more consistant feel to all the clips and echance the overall visual appeal. I'd like to experiment with more effects in future projects, I especially enjoyed creating effects for the text elements.

Bibliography

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freesound_community, n.d. *irish-countryside-in-late-spring*. [Sound Recording] (Pixabay).

freesound_community, n.d. *sheep*. [Sound Recording] (Pixabay).

Sounds, E. C., 2020. *Car Interior While Driving | HQ Sound Effect*. [Sound Recording] (Everyday Cinematic Sounds).